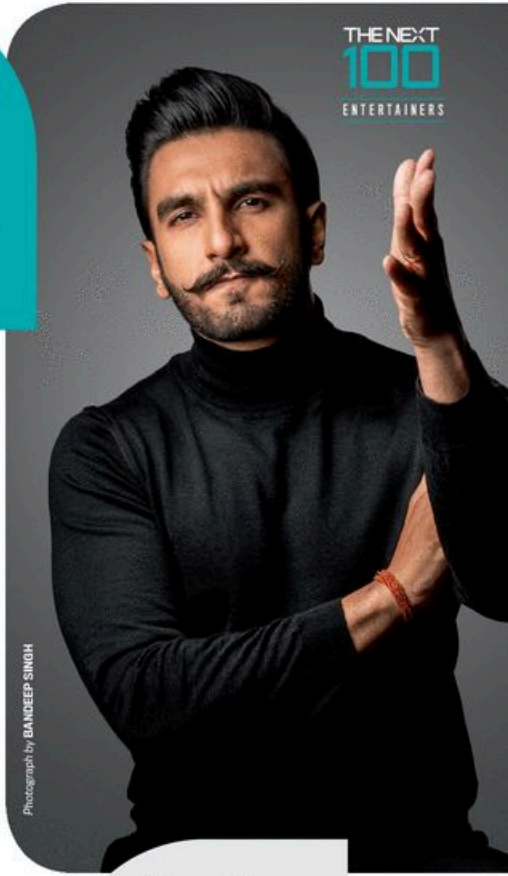
Chameleon King

RANVEER SINGH, 36

Actor



Photograph by BANDEEP SINGH

"I am not the kind of person to half-ass anything," says Ranveer Singh. It shows in the impressive body of work he has accumulated in just a decade-long career. Be it the ruthless antagonist upstaging the good king in *Padmaavat*, an aspiring rapper in *Gully Boy*, the deceitful lover in *Lootera* or even his spirited debut in *Band Baaja Baaraat*, Singh has the ability to sink himself into any role and play it with utmost conviction. The more they demand of him, the more he thrives.

"I approach every day at work like it's my first day or my last day, with full commitment," he says. "Logically, if you spend enough years in show business, some complacency starts creeping in. With me, it's the opposite. The more work I do, the more I enjoy it because I understand that the scope within the craft is limitless. Almost every day, I experience a moment I could never have imagined."

This child-like enthusiasm combined with a methodical approach to his work has won him a legion of fans who know that walking in to see a Ranveer Singh film means inhabiting for two hours a universe he's created for them.

Only a few actors in Hindi cinema have the distinction of being box office stars and dynamic performers. Singh belongs to that rare breed and, given his unwavering passion and astute choices when it comes to collaborators, he's here to stay. ■

–Suhani Singh

GETTING INTO THE MOOD To get into a part, Singh devises a theme-based playlist. His love for music has seen him start a record label, Inclnk, which provides a platform for local hip-hop talent.

"I have gotten detached from the result of the film and more attached to the creative process. I subscribe to the notion that the process is the prize"